The Holiday Screen Deal

Two weeks off school, one deal made together.
Agreed on day one, so nobody argues on day six.



Our holiday deal | My daily core | The jobs board | Two week grid

Ages 5 to 12

Written for the Christmas holidays, and it works for any school holiday: Easter, half term or the summer, two weeks at a time.

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FOR THE GROWN UP · READ THIS FIRST

Ten minutes on day one

School holidays take away the shape of the day, and screens rush in to fill the gap. By the third morning you are bargaining over breakfast. This planner puts a shape back, and you agree it once, together, at the kitchen table, before anybody is cross. Then the deal does the arguing, and you get to be on the same side as your child.

1 · THE CORE

A small amount of screen time that is theirs every day, no stars needed. It keeps the screen from becoming the prize. It does not carry over to tomorrow.

2 · EARNED TIME

Jobs earn stars. One star is five minutes, on any screen in the house. A weekly cap keeps the total sensible, and the count starts fresh each Monday.

3 · PROTECTED

Meals, the hour before bed, family days. No number of stars can buy these. A screen wanted then becomes an ask, never a sneaky start.

THE TEN MINUTE SETUP

1. Print the deal, the jobs board and both weeks. Read the deal out loud together.
2. Fill in the core and your star rate. Five minutes a star is where the app starts.
3. Choose the jobs together. Let your child suggest at least two of them.
4. Agree the protected times and the weekly cap, then both sign.
5. Stick the deal and week one on the fridge. Two minutes each evening fills in the day.

WHERE TO START THE NUMBERS

In the holidays the Guided Childhood app starts from the age guidance, loosened a little: about **70 minutes a day at 5 to 7**, **90 at 8 to 10** and **110 at 11 to 12**. A week of core plus the cap is the most screen time the week can hold, so set them to land near that. Say your child is 8: a core of 30 minutes and a cap of 84 stars comes to 90 minutes a day, if every star is earned. Your family, your numbers.

HOW AN ASK WORKS

A film on Christmas Eve, a call with cousins at teatime. Asks are allowed. You answer every one with a yes, or with a not now and what comes next: "after lunch", "tomorrow morning", "once the walk is done". Your child always knows the next step.



EACH EVENING, TWO MINUTES

Colour the core dots on the week grid, write the stars earned and the minutes used, and let your child draw the day's face. That small habit is the whole planner. On Monday the star count starts fresh.

Stars count when a grown up says yes to the job. Earned stars are never taken back, so consequences live somewhere else. If the deal is not working by day seven, change one thing together. A deal you both still believe in beats a perfect one that nobody keeps.

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DAY ONE · READ IT OUT LOUD, THEN BOTH SIGN

Our holiday deal



The _____ family

These holidays run from _____ to _____

1 My core screen time

_____ minutes a day are mine.

No stars needed. Whatever else happens, this is mine. It does not carry over to tomorrow.

2 Our star rate

1 star = _____ minutes.

Five is where most families start. Stars work on any screen: TV, tablet, console, phone, computer.

3 The weekly cap

Up to _____ stars a week,

that is _____ minutes.

When the cap is reached, the jar is full until Monday, when it starts fresh.

4 Our protected times

No stars can buy these. Tick ours.

- ☐ **Mealtimes**
- ☐ **Screens rest from _____**
- ☐ **Family days: _____**
- ☐ _____

5 How an ask works

MY HALF

If I want a screen in a protected time, I ask. I do not just start.

OUR HALF

We always answer. A yes, or a not now and what comes next.

Our not now words _____

Like "after lunch", "tomorrow morning" or "once the walk is done".

SIGNED BY ME _____ SIGNED BY MY GROWN UP _____ DATE _____

We check this deal again on day seven, and change one thing together if we need to.

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